
Implementation

Between design and actual execution Transdisciplinary Education, implementation is a challenge in itself. This last page of the design path discusses the support from your institution. Concrete questions and examples prepare you to get started.

You have now designed a framework for the curriculum. The next step is finding a way to incorporate this into your institution. Support from your institution is obviously essential for a successful practice. Transdisciplinary education needs space for experimentation, so it is important to think about the allocation of sufficient time and financial resources from the different partners for the testing phase.

A frequent problem for existing projects, is the pilot-format in which transdisciplinary education is initially developed – often led by enthusiastic individuals. A lack of supporting sustainable frameworks, complicates embedding in the organisation. Advancing from a pilot project is only possible when you are given the space and time to work on the project sustainability.

You can allocate time and resources in different ways, and resources can come from different sources as well. For example, you might link the transdisciplinary programme to a research group that has the financial resources to participate,

and can use the final results for its own further research. Social partners can also provide a location for the students and invest time to engage with them.

Some other questions to think about are:

- How much time is needed from each participant to participate in a transdisciplinary team?
- Is there time for experimentation?
- Is this time distributed equally?
- How do you ensure that the time is managed properly?
- Who provides the money? Some possibilities are: the university as part of educational programmes, external funding or co-funding from collaborating partners.

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- Another question is who receives payment. Participants (partners, researchers and teachers) may be paid for the work they do, or they participate for the sake of the common goal and experience the outcome of the project as a service in return.

Recruitment

Once you have the organisational issues in place, it is time to think about who might participate in the programme. Here, we focus mainly on students, but also on external partners. Which participants would you like to involve and what are the criteria to participate?

- 1. **Motivation:** we believe that motivation is the most important criterion for selecting participants; every motivated participant should have the opportunity to participate in transdisciplinary education.
- Another good motivator is to focus on a social problem. Many students are looking for their own goals, what they can contribute to society. Thus, they are likely to connect to a topic close to their own areas of interest. This creates a collaboration and learning experience that derives from intrinsic motivation.
- **Diversity:** when recruiting students - but this also applies to other stakeholders - it is also important to pay attention to the different disciplines and faculties students come from, as diversity in backgrounds is a basic feature of transdisciplinarity. After all, when students have similar backgrounds, they will more easily share the same views. Bringing students from different academic backgrounds together creates a

confrontation with different perspectives from the start.

When recruiting for diversity, you can adopt two different approaches:

- **• Selecting based on the wicked problem which students are needed. This ensures a targeted approach to the wicked problem.**
- **• Leaving it open to every student regardless of their background. This ensures an inclusive way of collaborating and might create learning surprises that were difficult to determine beforehand.**

How it might all come together, a practical example:

Utrecht University's Open Source Global Justice Investigation Lab, offers a great

example of a transdisciplinary education project. Co-initiator Brianne McGoningle talks about the content, challenges and success of the lab. Watch to the end to not miss any of her tips!